

Saturday, 16 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

14° 8°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

13° 6°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

12° 7°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

13° 5°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 The pound has fallen and UK borrowing costs have risen amid ongoing political leadership discussions.

Financial analysts suggest these market movements are linked to concerns about potential changes to government borrowing policies under a new administration. It's certainly a topic of conversation in the City.

POLITICS · UK

2 An NHS hospital trust has admitted that staff inappropriately accessed patient records in Southport.

The trust confirmed that records of victims were accessed without proper authorisation. Worryingly, those affected by this data breach weren't informed for almost two years after it happened.

HEALTHCARE · UK

3 A British soldier has parachuted onto a remote island to deliver vital medical aid.

A specialist team, including the soldier, provided critical support to Tristan da Cunha, a tiny community in the South Atlantic. They were bringing help for a Hantavirus outbreak, ensuring the islanders received the medical assistance they needed.

HEALTH · UK FORCES

What's coming up

- 1 Discussions are continuing about how recent events might shape the future of the Eurovision Song Contest.**
Following significant debate and calls for boycotts, questions are now being raised about the competition's direction. Organisers will certainly be looking at how to navigate these challenges for upcoming events.
EUROVISION · FUTURE
- 2 The new Spotify logo is sparking plenty of online debate, offering a look at how public opinion forms on social media.**
The streaming giant's updated 'disco ball' look has certainly divided opinion across various platforms. It's a fascinating example of how new designs can generate instant and sometimes passionate reactions online.
TECH · ONGOING
- 3 Music superstars Madonna, Shakira, and BTS are set to headline the World Cup final's half-time show this summer.**
The global pop icons will be performing during the Super Bowl-style spectacle. It promises to be a huge highlight, adding an extra layer of entertainment to the major sporting event.
MUSIC · THIS SUMMER

On the schedule

- 1 Celtic's Scottish Premiership title hopes have been boosted by a controversial late penalty decision.**
A 99th-minute penalty against Motherwell has kept their title dreams alive. This sets up a dramatic final-day showdown against Hearts, where everything will be on the line.
FOOTBALL · SCOTLAND
- 2 England's Jude Bellingham was on the scoresheet for Real Madrid in their latest La Liga victory.**
Bellingham scored in Real Madrid's 2-0 win against Real Oviedo. Meanwhile, there was a hostile reception for Kylian Mbappe from supporters during the match.
FOOTBALL · EUROPEAN
- 3 The Scottish Football Association says referee John Beaton and his family have been under police surveillance.**
This action follows a recent penalty controversy involving the official. The SFA highlighted the serious nature of the situation, ensuring the family's safety.
FOOTBALL · SCOTLAND
- 4 Wales has recalled Seren Singleton to their squad for Sunday's crucial Six Nations game against Italy.**
Singleton returns on the wing as the only change to the team. It's a must-win match for Wales in their final game of the tournament.
RUGBY · WALES

Quick hits

- 1 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 2 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 3 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 4 Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.
- 5 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 6 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 7 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.

Q Asked 'what's the most British thing about your morning?', the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**
Talk-back: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right? Or the quickest you DID like someone?
- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**
Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds — about the same as 100 elephants. They float because they're spread across miles of sky.
- Honey never spoils. Edible honey has been found in 3,000-year-old Egyptian tombs.
- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood. Two pump blood through the gills, the third pumps it round the body.
- The Eiffel Tower can grow up to 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in the heat.
- The dot above a lowercase 'i' or 'j' has a name — it's called a tittle.
- Bananas are technically berries. Strawberries, somehow, are not.
- Wombats produce cube-shaped poo. Scientists worked out it's the elasticity of their intestines.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second. So 'back in a jiffy' is the fastest promise you can make.

On this day

Day 136 of the year, 229 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Abda and Abdjesus, and companions: Abdas of Susa; Christian feast day: Andrew Bobola; Christian feast day: Brendan the Navigator (Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion, Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Billy Cobham, Panamanian-American drummer, composer, and bandleader
- 1965 — Krist Novoselic, American bass player, songwriter, author, and activist
- 1921 — Harry Carey Jr., American actor, producer, and screenwriter (died 2012)
- 1953 — Peter Onorati, American actor
- 1929 — Betty Carter, American singer-songwriter (died 1998)
- 1971 — Phil Clarke, English rugby league player and sportscaster
- 1973 — Tori Spelling, American actress, reality television personality, and author
- 1974 — Sonny Sandoval, American singer-songwriter and rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 1919 — A naval Curtiss NC-4 aircraft commanded by Albert Cushing Read leaves Trepassey, Newfoundland, for Lisbon via the Azores on the first transatlantic flight.
- 1991 — Queen Elizabeth II of the United Kingdom addresses a joint session of the United States Congress. She is the first British monarch to address the U.S. Congress.
- 1972 — An Antonov An-24 crashes into a kindergarten building in Svetlogorsk, killing 35.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1961 — Park Chung Hee leads a coup d'état to overthrow the Second Republic of South Korea.
- 2014 — Twelve people are killed in two explosions in the Gikomba market area of Nairobi, Kenya.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1974 — Josip Broz Tito is elected president for life of Yugoslavia.
- 1975 — Junko Tabei from Japan becomes the first woman to reach the summit of Mount Everest.
- 2005 — Kuwait permits women's suffrage in a 35–23 National Assembly vote.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 137 of the year, 228 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of the Raja (Perlis); Christian feast day: Giulia Salzano; Christian feast day: Blessed Ivan Ziatyk; Christian feast day: Paschal Baylon. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1986 — Jodie Taylor, English footballer
- 1962 — Jane Moore, English journalist and author
- 1985 — Derek Hough, American actor, singer, and dancer
- 1938 — Jason Bernard, American actor (died 1996)
- 1931 — Dewey Redman, American saxophonist (died 2006)
- 1958 — Paul Di'Anno, English rock singer-songwriter (died 2024)
- 1942 — Taj Mahal, American blues singer-songwriter and musician
- 1974 — Andrea Corr, Irish singer-songwriter, pianist, and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — In Cuba, the First Agrarian Reform Law – a cornerstone of the Cuban Revolution – was signed by Fidel Castro, aiming to eliminate large foreign-owned estates and redistribute land to over 100,000 peasants.
- 2004 — The first legal same-sex marriages in the U.S. are performed in the state of Massachusetts.
- 1967 — Six-Day War: President Gamal Abdel Nasser of Egypt demands dismantling of the peace-keeping UN Emergency Force in Egypt.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2010 — Pamir Airways Flight 112 crashes in Afghanistan's Shakardara District, killing 44.
- 1980 — General Chun Doo-hwan of South Korea seizes control of the government and declares martial law in order to suppress student demonstrations.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026

FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)

JUNE 2026

FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026

WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		